

Phonetician and speech technology engineer; 15+ years across speech production and perception research, applied speech AI for language assessment, and computational linguistics.

Contact

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 U.S. Citizen

Skills

Programming

- Python, R, SQL
- Bash, $\text{\LaTeX}$

ML/AI

- PyTorch, Scikit-learn
- HuggingFace
- Speech recognition, NLP
- Coding agents
- Prompt engineering

Infrastructure

- Docker, Terraform
- CI/CD (GitHub/GitLab)
- HPC: AWS, SGE, Slurm

Education

PhD, Linguistics
 U of Arizona, 2015
 Phonetics, Cognitive Science

M.S., Linguistics
 U of Arizona, 2011
 Human Language Technology

M.A., East Asian Studies
 U of Arizona, 2008
 Japanese Linguistics

B.A., East Asian Studies
 Oakland University, 2003

Languages

English (native)
 Japanese
 Mandarin

Experience

Lecturer

Jan 2026 – May 2026

University of Arizona, Tucson, AZ (remote)

Taught online “LING 538: Computational Linguistics”, “LING 581: Advanced Computational Linguistics”, and “LING 696G: Advanced Speech Technology”.

Independent Software Engineer

May 2025 – present

Designed and built a Flask web application for Gage R&R measurement system analysis in manufacturing. Implemented variance component estimation and statistical tests to assess repeatability and reproducibility across operators, parts, and trials, with reporting aligned to AIAG and Six Sigma standards.

Lecturer

Jan 2025 – May 2025

University of Arizona, Tucson, AZ (remote)

Taught online “LING 539: Statistical Natural Language Processing”.

Associate AI Engineer

2020 – 2024

ETS, San Francisco, CA, and remote

- Architected a generalized scoring engine framework that became the base for 4 language learning applications deployed in the China and India markets.
- Trained and deployed updated speech and text scoring models for annual TOEFL and TOEIC assessment cycles.
- Reduced user-facing latency of speech services by 80% through caching, vectorization, and systematic operation-level latency analysis.
- Built user behavior simulations to optimize infrastructure scaling, enabling 200 concurrent users through language learning progressions.
- Led development of speech feedback features including sentence stress, lexical stress, and speech rhythm analysis.
- Led a team of 2–3 engineers on speech feature development.
- Served as liaison between Infrastructure/Architecture and product development teams, driving prioritization and division of labor across groups.
- Chaired the AI Ethics Working Group, compiling resources and methods for ethical application of AI within the engineering labs.
- Coordinated the AI Ethics Lecture Series, inviting 10 outside experts to present research on topics central to the lab’s work.

Manager, Living Zen Organics, Detroit, MI

2017 – 2019

Postdoctoral Research Fellow

2015 – 2017

Alberta Phonetics Laboratory, University of Alberta, Edmonton, Canada

- Contributed to development of the Massive Auditory Lexical Decision (MALD) database, a large-scale auditory psycholinguistic resource subsequently published in *Behavior Research Methods*.
- Managed experimental projects based on the corpus, and publicized the corpus widely at conferences.

Publications

Full publications list (PDF): https://github.com/dbqpdb/db_cv/blob/master/DanBrenner_Dissemination.pdf